

Complex Animation Design for Moral Trade Types

Executive Summary

This research began with the user-specified source on `amirrorclear.net`: Toby Ord's 2015 paper *Moral Trade*. I then cross-checked its publication record, author summary, practical legal examples, implementation tooling, and accessibility guidance using the official *Ethics* record, Toby Ord's research page, the Ninth Circuit's *Porter v. Bowen* opinion, the FEC materials on Repledge/OnePledge, OpenAI's Codex documentation, official animation-engine documentation, and W3C accessibility guidance. ¹

Ord's paper explicitly defines **moral trade** as trade made possible by differences in the parties' moral views, and distinguishes **pure moral trade** from **mixed moral trade**. It also presents an **intrapersonal** edge case and sketches mechanism-level forms including **moral barter**, **bargaining**, **lotteries**, **side payments**, **markets**, **currency**, and **professionalization**. Because the user asked for an animation for "each type," the most production-useful reading is to separate: foundational value-structure types, the intrapersonal edge case, and the main mechanism-types that Ord actually develops with figures and examples. ²

On that basis, the strongest animation suite is an **eight-film system**: reciprocal mixed trade, moral-for-prudential trade, pure opposed-cause trade, intrapersonal trade, bargained coordination, lottery-mediated trade, side-payment trade, and market-mediated trade. This covers the paper's key conceptual ground without collapsing its most important distinctions. It also maps cleanly onto the paper's own visual logic: conflicting value systems, default/status-quo points, Pareto-superior regions, probability arcs, and compensating side-payment lines. ³

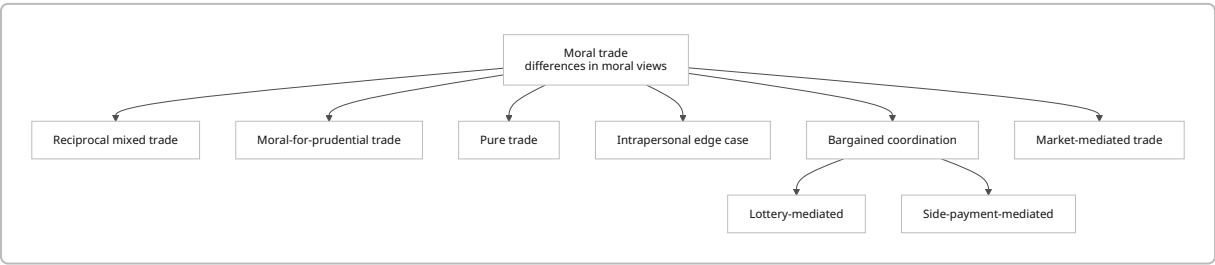
The best overall implementation route for Codex-driven production is a **programmatic 2D motion-graphics pipeline** with **Remotion** as the default render engine, **Motion Canvas** as an alternative for signal-driven scene graphs, and **Manim** for the graph-centric bargaining, lottery, and side-payment sequences. Remotion is especially well suited because it models videos as React compositions with explicit frame counts and provides built-in interpolation and spring primitives; Motion Canvas is strong for scene generators and signals; Manim is strong for precisely structured explanatory animation and rate functions; and Three.js or Blender should be reserved for optional depth-heavy or interactive sequences rather than the default build. ⁴

Accessibility should not be an afterthought. The safest design rule-set is: avoid red/green dependence, use redundant coding through shapes and labels, meet at least WCAG AA contrast thresholds for text and meaningful graphics, provide captions for all meaningful audio, supply audio description or a full text alternative for dense visual-only sequences, and ship reduced-motion variants that replace pans, zooms, and large-scale motion with opacity changes or stepwise state transitions. The ethical note is equally important: Ord emphasizes that moral trade is not guaranteed to be objectively best; it is guaranteed only to look better from the parties' perspectives, and it can create externalities or perverse incentives. The animations should therefore portray **structured disagreement and negotiated gains**, not moral triumphalism. ⁵

Source Basis and Working Typology

The paper itself is the primary source, and it is enough to ground the conceptual extraction. The secondary sources mainly help in four places: publication confirmation, practical market examples, implementation tooling, and accessibility. Toby Ord’s own summary reinforces that the gains from moral trade may be large even across very different moral views; the Ninth Circuit opinion clarifies how vote-swapping sites operated and why they mattered as a real market-like facilitation layer; the FEC/OnePledge materials show the mechanics of a donation-matching/cancellation platform; and the animation/accessibility sources help convert the philosophy into buildable, accessible motion systems. 6

Because Ord uses “type” at more than one level, I adopt a **working typology** with two tiers: **value-structure types** and **mechanism types**. This is analytically faithful to the paper and production-friendly for animation design. 7



The typology above reflects Ord’s explicit definitions of pure and mixed trade, his intrapersonal edge case, and his development of bargaining, randomness, side payments, and organized markets. 8

ID	Animation target	Definition extracted from the paper	Key actors	Inputs → outputs	Dynamics to show	Visual essence
A	Reciprocal mixed trade	In Victoria–Paul style trade, both sides accept a small prudential cost for what each sees as a moral gain ; Ord summarizes this as “moral gain plus small prudential cost versus moral gain plus small prudential cost.” 9	Two friends with different moral weightings	Vegetarianism + 1% income donation → more animal welfare + more poverty relief	Reciprocal promise, continuing compliance, trust	Two differently weighted value systems finding an overlap bridge

ID	Animation target	Definition extracted from the paper	Key actors	Inputs → outputs	Dynamics to show	Visual essence
B	Moral-for-prudential trade	Ord's example of Victoria paying someone to become vegetarian is mixed trade where one side sees "moral gain plus small prudential cost" and the other sees "pure prudential gain." He also notes related cases of specialization/ professionalization through donations that pay others to do good acts. ¹⁰	One moral agent, one fence-sitter or service provider	Money/ incentive → changed behavior or outsourced good deed	Incentive alignment rather than reciprocity	A behavior is "purchased" into moral alignment
C	Pure trade between opposed causes	Pure moral trade is where both parties view the result as morally superior . Ord's Rebecca-Christopher vignette turns offsetting donations to opposed causes into a shared donation to Oxfam, which both judge better than funding both sides of a zero-sum battle. ¹¹	Two opponents plus optional onlooker/ matcher	Opposing donations → redirected compromise donation	Cancellation of conflict produces jointly endorsed surplus	Zero-sum vectors collapse into a common good

ID	Animation target	Definition extracted from the paper	Key actors	Inputs → outputs	Dynamics to show	Visual essence
D	Intrapersonal moral trade	Ord describes intrapersonal trade as an edge case where one person's prudential and moral considerations can be reorganized into another pair of actions that is better on both dimensions, as in Alex flying while offsetting twice the emissions. He does not formally include it in the definition, but says some of the theory still applies. ¹²	One person split across value systems	Desire + moral concern + offset payment → travel plus improved climate contribution	Internal negotiation rather than interpersonal exchange	A divided self converges on a better bundle
E	Bargained coordination trade	Ord's graph-based analysis shows cases where collaboration on A or B would create more total value, but no non-randomized team-up option lies above and to the right of the default . If repeated, parties can alternate or bargain over outcomes. ¹³	Two parties, projects A and B	Joint labor/coordination → higher collective output	Default point blocks direct agreement; repeated interaction enables alternation	Negotiation around a constrained Pareto frontier

ID	Animation target	Definition extracted from the paper	Key actors	Inputs → outputs	Dynamics to show	Visual essence
F	Lottery-mediated trade	When no direct team-up option dominates default, Ord proposes a weighted lottery between A and B. The resulting options span an arc or line from A to B, and some randomizations may dominate default. ¹⁴	Two parties plus randomization device	Probability weights → one jointly executed project	Chance creates a bridge into the win-win region	Probability as a curved bridge across disagreement
G	Side-payment trade	Ord's second escape route is a side payment in a more or less continuous medium, illustrated by charitable side payments that can move options into the Pareto-superior quadrant and may dominate the lottery approach. ¹⁵	Two parties plus compensation channel	Project choice + donation transfer → compensated agreement	Compensation reshapes feasibility	A diagonal compensation stream shifts the deal into acceptability

ID	Animation target	Definition extracted from the paper	Key actors	Inputs → outputs	Dynamics to show	Visual essence
H	Market-mediated trade	Ord explicitly says moral barter could be scaled into equivalents of currency, markets, bargaining, and professionalization. His practical cases include legislative vote trades, public vote-swapping sites, donation-cancelling markets, and a more complete-market vision akin to eBay/Craigslist with prices and perhaps special-purpose currency. The Ninth Circuit opinion shows how vote-swap sites matched users; the Repledge/OnePledge materials show a matching-and-clearing flow for redirecting matched political pledges to charities. ¹⁶	Many traders, platform, matcher, payment processor, optional escrow	Offers, prices, match ratios, trust mechanisms → cleared exchanges and residual unmatched flows	Search, matching, clearing, and trust at scale	A moral exchange network rather than a single handshake

The paper's own figures are especially useful for animation design because they already visualize choiceworthiness, default constraints, lottery arcs, and side-payment lines. Those diagrams strongly support using coordinate transforms, point motion, and shape interpolation as the master visual language for the coordination-oriented films. ¹⁷

Visual Grammar and Animation Concepts

A strong suite should look like one family while still giving each trade-type its own identity. The highest-confidence unifying grammar is: **dual-perspective layouts, visible status quo/default state,**

transformation of blocked flows into feasible ones, and surplus made legible as motion upward/rightward or as bloom/expansion. That is directly aligned with Ord’s graphs and examples. ¹⁸

For accessibility, the global color rule should follow Color Universal Design and WCAG logic: avoid red/green-only meaning, add redundant coding through shapes and labels, prefer distinguishable warm/cool alternation, keep meaningful graphics at least 3:1 against adjacent colors, and keep text at least 4.5:1 for standard text. The CUD guidance specifically warns against red/green ambiguity, recommends redundant coding, and explains why vermilion, bluish green, sky blue, blue, and reddish purple are safer differentiators. ¹⁹

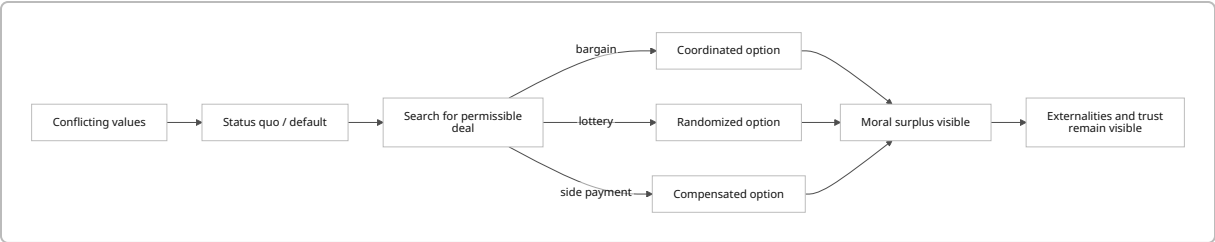
A good master palette system is therefore: near-black graphite background, warm vermilion/orange for one viewpoint, bluish green for the second, sky blue for neutral public goods, reddish purple for uncertainty/lottery, amber for money or side-payments, and off-white for captions and labels. Use dashed vs solid strokes, circles vs squares, and left vs right positioning so that color is never the only carrier of meaning. That recommendation is an inference from the accessibility sources, not a claim made by Ord. ²⁰

ID	Primary visual metaphor	Palette direction	Motion style	Signature key frames	Transition strategy	Sound cues
A	Bridge of overlap between two moral landscapes	Vermilion/amber for Victoria’s sacrifice channel, bluish green/sky blue for Paul’s poverty channel, off-white labels	Symmetrical mirrored motion, gentle elastic settle, recurring trust pulse	Split-screen frustration → offer cards cross → bridge forms → both moral meters rise	Direct morph from icons to bars to axis plot	Soft card-swap clicks, heartbeat-like trust pulse, paired chime on agreement
B	Behavior as a magnetized purchase	Gold/amber money stream, leaf-green target behavior, warm gray neutrals	Push-pull motion, coin stream morphs into leaves/behavior markers	Wallet opens → token stream → person’s plate/habit changes → moral halo appears	Match-cut through token shapes	Coin tings, muted whoosh, small upward shimmer

ID	Primary visual metaphor	Palette direction	Motion style	Signature key frames	Transition strategy	Sound cues
C	Cancellation into common reservoir	Opposed colors at start, converging into calm sky blue/white common-good field	Stronger counter-motion at first, then collapse and bloom	Two arrows collide → cancelled ledger lines vanish → shared reservoir fills	Hard cut on collision, soft dissolve into shared good	Tense taps during conflict, cancellation thump, choral swell
D	Interior cockpit / divided self	Midnight blue base, magenta “desire,” cyan “moral concern,” white final synthesis	Slow orbital motion, mirrored self-panels, low-parallax UI	Split self → plane path blocked → double-offset rings draw in → unified path launches	Holographic panel fold-in	Low synth drone, route beep, satisfying lock tone
E	Negotiation on the Pareto map	Slate/white graph, orange A, blue B, gray default cross	Precise mathematical motion, no bounce, subtle pan	Default cross appears → A/B team-up points fail → weekly calendar alternation flips → frontier settles	Shape-draw and point highlighting	Tick-tock, pen-draw scratch, quiet confirmation click

ID	Primary visual metaphor	Palette direction	Motion style	Signature key frames	Transition strategy	Sound cues
F	Probability arc	Reddish purple uncertainty arc, cyan/amber endpoint markers	Curved motion, weighted easing, particle trail on roulette point	A and B labeled → arc appears → probability point slides to feasible span → coin/lottery draw resolves	Arc writes itself; camera follows marker	Roulette ticks, suspended tone, resolving bell
G	Compensation line	Navy background, white axes, amber payment stream, compensated point in bluish green	Linear slide plus finite donation pulses	A/B points → parallel side-payment lines draw → donation packets travel → deal point crosses feasible boundary	Donation packets become axis displacement	Ledger clicks, receipt rip, bright but short confirmation tone
H	Moral exchange / clearinghouse	Charcoal with cyan network lines, amber price tags, magenta unmatched residuals, white labels	Dense but orderly node animation, batch matching, network bloom	Order book fills → matching engine pairs nodes → matched flows reroute → residual unmatched orders remain visible	Wipe in batches, not continuous chaos	Market pings, soft gate opens, clearing bell, residual low click

A helpful production distinction is that **A–D** should feel more character- and icon-driven, while **E–H** should feel more system- and graph-driven. That split tracks the paper itself: the early vignettes are person-centered, while the middle and later sections become formal, economic, and institutional. ²¹



That arc mirrors the paper’s structure: initial conflict, default constraint, search over feasible options, mechanism-specific resolution, and a reminder that trust and externalities remain part of the story. ²²

Storyboards and Shot Lists

All shot lists below assume **30 fps, 16:9**, and a default master render of **3840×2160**. Durations are recommendations rather than source-derived facts. The frame ranges are implementation-ready and intended to be directly portable to Remotion, Motion Canvas, or Manim.

A. Reciprocal mixed trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–179	6s	Left frame shows Victoria with an animal-welfare meter; right frame shows Paul with a poverty-relief meter. Each side also has a smaller prudential meter. Their priorities are visibly different, not opposed.
Friction	180–419	8s	Steak icon on Paul’s side and wallet icon on Victoria’s side generate dotted “if only” arrows across the split. Small labels show “would not choose this alone.”
Offer	420–719	10s	Two offer cards appear: “1% income” and “vegetarian.” They slide to center, rotate, and swap lanes. A minimalist handshake line becomes a bridge spanning the split.
Trade effect	720–1019	10s	Meat desaturates into a leaf on Paul’s side; Victoria’s donation stream becomes clinic, water, and aid icons. Prudential meters dip slightly; moral meters rise clearly on both sides.
Closure	1020–1259	8s	The bridge resolves into a unified two-axis mini-graph with the trade point above and right of the default. End card: “small prudential cost, bilateral moral gain.”

B. Moral-for-prudential trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–149	5s	A moral agent appears on the left, a fence-sitter on the right, with a behavior target in the middle: a plate/habit icon.
Incentive reveal	150–359	7s	A wallet and token stream appear from the moral agent. The fence-sitter's prudential meter brightens as the tokens approach.
Conversion	360–629	9s	Tokens hit the behavior target and morph into leaves/checkmarks. The behavior target flips from "not adopted" to "adopted."
Moral outcome	630–869	8s	The moral agent's outcome field blooms upward while the other party's gain remains explicitly prudential. The asymmetry is shown as intentional, not unfair.
Closure	870–1079	7s	A small caption panel reframes the sequence as mixed trade and briefly flashes the related professionalization idea: "others may perform the good act more efficiently."

C. Pure trade between opposed causes

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–179	6s	Rebecca and Christopher appear at opposite ends of the frame, each with a \$1,000 token stack and opposed campaign arrows traveling toward each other.
Zero-sum clash	180–419	8s	The arrows strike and cancel. The field fills with wasted heat/noise particles, making the zero-sum structure visible.
Common charity discovery	420–719	10s	A neutral Oxfam-like "shared aid" reservoir appears between them. Their opposing token stacks pivot toward the center, but hesitate.
Pure trade execution	720–1079	12s	Both stacks move simultaneously into the common reservoir, which fills and sends upward benefit rays. Their personal moral meters both rise.
Closure	1080–1319	8s	Final diagram shows two opposed vectors replaced by one upward common-good vector labeled "pure moral trade."

D. Intrapersonal moral trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–149	5s	One person is split into two semi-transparent selves: "prudential desire" and "moral concern." A plane route to Paris sits behind a red block.

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Conflict	150–299	5s	The desire-self advances toward the route; the moral-self pulls it back toward a climate icon. The route remains locked.
Reframing	300–539	8s	A friend-suggestion card or idea-bubble appears: “double offset.” Carbon tokens draw in around the plane path.
Integrated action	540–809	9s	The offsets build two concentric rings; the block dissolves; the two selves merge into a single figure who follows the route.
Closure	810–1019	7s	A two-column internal dashboard shows prudential value improved and moral value improved relative to staying home without offsetting.

E. Bargained coordination trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–179	6s	A clean coordinate graph appears with a default cross and two prominent points, A and B, each tied to one party’s preferred joint project.
Constraint	180–419	8s	A and B highlight in turn, but each fails one party’s acceptability test relative to default. No point lies in the feasible upper-right region.
Repetition enters	420–659	8s	A weekly timeline or calendar wheel slides in. A and B alternate across weeks, visibly averaging into a fairer pattern.
Bargain	660–959	10s	The animation compares “one-off impossible” with “repeated fair alternation.” Frontier points pulse, and the moral surplus lost to bargaining is shown as faint unclaimed glow.
Closure	960–1199	8s	End card: “when single-shot agreement fails, repeated structure can recover gains.”

F. Lottery-mediated trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–149	5s	Reuse the graph setup from E, but simplify the background to emphasize A, B, and default.
Arc construction	150–329	6s	A curved arc or segment is drawn from A to B, visualizing the space of weighted lotteries.
Search	330–539	7s	A glowing probability marker slides along the arc, with numeric weights updating subtly. The moment it enters the feasible region is emphasized.

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Randomized resolution	540–779	8s	A coin/roulette device resolves the selected mix into an actual project, and both parties move together toward the winning project.
Closure	780–1019	8s	Final caption: “chance can create a mutually acceptable path when certainty cannot.”

G. Side-payment trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–149	5s	A graph similar to E/F appears, this time with A and B plus space for compensation lines.
Compensation field	150–359	7s	Parallel side-payment lines draw outward from A and B. Amber donor tokens begin to travel along one line.
Crossing into feasibility	360–629	9s	As donation tokens move, the active deal point slides upward/rightward and crosses into the acceptable quadrant.
Compare with lottery	630–899	9s	The lottery arc from F appears faintly in the background, while the compensated point sits above it, making Ord’s “can dominate the randomized approach” intuition legible.
Closure	900–1139	8s	End card: “continuous side payments can reshape the deal space.”

H. Market-mediated trade

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Setup	0–179	6s	Start with a single barter-style trade card between two people, then rapidly zoom out to reveal many nodes entering a shared marketplace.
Matching layer	180–479	10s	A market board fills with offers, requests, ratios, and cause-tags. The matching engine pairs vote-swap style offers across safe/swing-state or opposed-cause lanes.
Clearing layer	480–839	12s	A clearing animation processes matched pairs. For the donation variant, matched shares route to charities while unmatched residuals remain with political committees, echoing the Repledge/OnePledge logic.
Trust and infrastructure	840–1199	12s	Escrow, receipts, audits, and reputation badges appear. Two callouts labeled “factual trust” and “counterfactual trust” pulse at the edges.

Shot	Frames	Duration	Frame description
Closure	1200–1499	10s	The market condenses into an abstract “moral exchange” emblem with optional sublabels: barter, bargaining, currency, markets, professionalization.

For visual reference, the bargaining, lottery, and side-payment animations should borrow directly from the structural logic of Ord’s figures: Pareto-optimal dots, the default cross with an upper-right feasible zone, the lottery arc/segment between A and B, and side-payment lines extending from A or B. ¹⁷

Codex-Ready Implementation Specification

OpenAI’s current Codex guidance is highly compatible with this project: plan first for difficult tasks, break complex work into smaller focused steps, give the agent one objective and one stopping condition, point it at the files and docs it must read first, use repository guidance files such as `AGENTS.md`, and keep work in checkpoints. Current Codex docs also confirm that Codex can read, edit, and run code, and that GPT-5.5 is the recommended current model for most Codex tasks when available. ²³

A repository structure that will be easy for Codex to reason over is:

```
moral-trade-animations/
  AGENTS.md
  docs/
    moral-trade-report.md
    style-guide.md
    accessibility-checklist.md
  scene-specs/
    A-reciprocal-mixed.json
    B-moral-for-prudential.json
    C-pure-opposed-cause.json
    D-intrapersonal.json
    E-bargained-coordination.json
    F-lottery.json
    G-side-payment.json
    H-market-mediated.json
  assets/
    icons/
    textures/
    audio/
    captions/
  src/
    components/
      Axis.tsx
      Meters.tsx
      TokenStream.tsx
      OfferCard.tsx
```

```
    NetworkMatcher.tsx
    Captions.tsx
  scenes/
    A.tsx
    B.tsx
    C.tsx
    D.tsx
    E.tsx
    F.tsx
    G.tsx
    H.tsx
  Root.tsx
```

That layout aligns with Codex's documented preference for explicit project instructions, file-first prompting, and task scoping. ²⁴

A minimal `AGENTS.md` should instruct Codex to: read `docs/style-guide.md` and the target `scene-specs/*.json` first; generate one scene at a time; render a preview after each scene; enforce caption and reduced-motion variants; and avoid adding dependencies unless necessary. This is directly in line with Codex's documented workflow guidance. ²⁵

A generic scene schema that works across Remotion, Motion Canvas, or a custom renderer:

```
type EasingName =
  | "linear"
  | "easeInSine"
  | "easeOutCubic"
  | "easeInOutSine"
  | "easeInOutCubic"
  | "springSoft"
  | "springFirm";

type Keyframe = {
  frame: number;
  props: Record<string, number | string | boolean>;
  ease?: EasingName;
};

type NodeSpec = {
  id: string;
  kind:
    | "group"
    | "svg"
    | "text"
    | "icon"
    | "meter"
```

```

    | "tokenStream"
    | "axis"
    | "graphPoint"
    | "line"
    | "particleField"
    | "audioCue";
parent?: string;
asset?: string;
props: Record<string, unknown>;
keyframes?: Keyframe[];
children?: string[];
};

type SceneSpec = {
  id: string;
  fps: 30;
  width: 3840;
  height: 2160;
  durationInFrames: number;
  background: {color: string; texture?: string};
  palette: Record<string, string>;
  nodes: NodeSpec[];
  captions: {start: number; end: number; text: string}[];
  audio: {frame: number; cue: string; gainDb?: number}[];
  reducedMotionOverrides?: Record<string, unknown>;
};

```

A renderer pseudocode skeleton for Remotion-style execution:

```

function renderScene(spec: SceneSpec, frame: number) {
  const ctx = createSceneContext(spec, frame);

  for (const node of topologicallySort(spec.nodes)) {
    const base = node.props;
    const animated = interpolateProps(node.keyframes ?? [], frame);
    const props = applyReducedMotionIfNeeded(
      merge(base, animated),
      spec.reducedMotionOverrides,
      node.id
    );
    drawNode(ctx, node.kind, props, node.asset);
  }

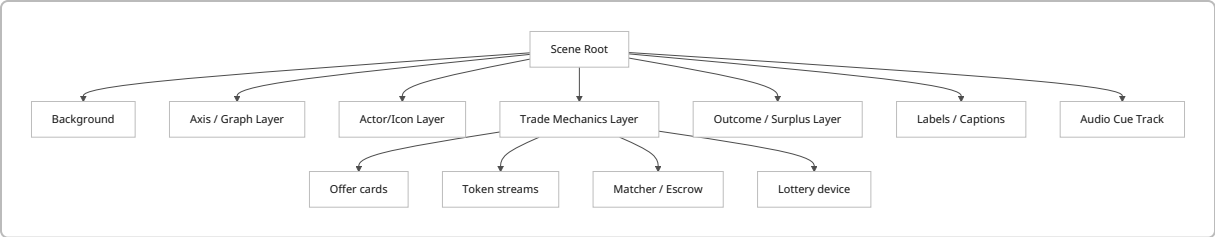
  renderCaptions(spec.captions, frame);
}

```



```
triggerAudioCues(spec.audio, frame);
}
```

This maps naturally onto Remotion's frame-driven compositions and interpolation/spring helpers, Motion Canvas's generator-and-signal model, and Manim's explicit scene and rate-function model. 26



A practical motion-parameter library:

```
const MOTION = {
  reveal: "easeOutCubic",
  compare: "easeInOutSine",
  settle: "easeInOutCubic",
  pulse: {type: "springSoft", stiffness: 90, damping: 14, mass: 1},
  emphasize: {type: "springFirm", stiffness: 120, damping: 16, mass: 1},
  cameraPanMaxPct: 4, // keep low for accessibility
  zoomMaxPct: 8, // disable in reduced-motion mode
  opacityFadeFrames: 12,
  labelSlidePx: 80,
  tokenBurstCount: 12,
};
```

The choices above are intentionally conservative: smooth explanatory curves for most motion, limited bounce, and spring only for emphasis or agreement-lock moments. That is consistent with Remotion's explicit spring/interpolation model and Manim's canonical easing families. 27

Per-animation implementation mapping:

ID	Best default engine	Scene-graph focus	Core reusable assets	Key animation parameters	Fallback simplification
A	Remotion or Motion Canvas	Two avatars, four meters, bridge, offer cards, mini-graph	2 avatars, animal/poverty icons, bridge SVG, meter component	Reciprocal card swap at f420–540; bridge draw f500–650; moral meter rise +18–25%; prudential dip –4–6%	Replace avatars with labeled circles and icon tags

ID	Best default engine	Scene-graph focus	Core reusable assets	Key animation parameters	Fallback simplification
B	Remotion; exportable Lottie variant possible	Wallet, token stream, behavior target, halo	Wallet, coin tokens, plate, leaf, checkmark	Token emission ramp f180–420; morph progress 0→1 over 45 frames; prudential glow +20%	Replace morph with crossfade between “before” and “after” icons
C	Remotion or Motion Canvas	Opposed vectors, cancellation field, shared reservoir	2 avatars, vector arrows, reservoir, aid icons	Counter-motion amplitude 1.0→1.3 before collision; cancellation burst at frame 420; fill level 0→100% by frame 980	Skip particles; use simple arrow collision and fill meter
D	Remotion	Split-self panels, route path, offset rings	Single avatar duplicated, plane path, carbon icons, UI cards	Internal split width 50/50→0/100 by frame 760; offset ring draw segment 0→1 over 120 frames	Use two columns and a single route card, no cockpit UI
E	Manim or Motion Canvas	Axes, default cross, A/B points, timeline/ calendar	Axis component, labeled points, weekly timeline	Point pulse radius 12→20 px; calendar alternation cycle every 45 frames	Static graph with alternating highlight and no timeline sweep
F	Manim	A/B points, arc/segment, probability marker, roulette device	Axis component, gradient arc, spinner/coin	Marker pathProgress 0→1 over 180 frames; selected weight label fade-in after frame 420	Use straight segment instead of curve; remove roulette device
G	Manim	A/B points, side-payment lines, donation packets	Axis component, compensation lines, packet sprites	Packet cadence every 12 frames; deal point x/y shift +140/+110 px into feasible zone	Show single amber line and one moving packet only

ID	Best default engine	Scene-graph focus	Core reusable assets	Key animation parameters	Fallback simplification
H	Remotion; optional Three.js enhancement	Order book, network graph, matcher, escrow, residual unmatched flows	Network nodes, queue cards, escrow icon, reputation badge, residual order markers	Batch match every 30 frames; network bloom +15% on clear; residual unmatched pulse every 60 frames	Pure 2D network; no camera, no 3D depth, no particle clutter

Tool recommendations by output mode:

- **Remotion** should be the default for the production master because it uses React compositions with explicit frame metadata and built-in interpolation/spring helpers, which makes it unusually compatible with Codex-generated code and testable scene components. ²⁸
- **Motion Canvas** is a strong alternate stack if the team prefers generator-based scene authoring and signal-driven dependency updates. ²⁹
- **Manim** is the best fit for E, F, and G if mathematical clarity matters more than brand-heavy motion design. ³⁰
- **Three.js** is useful only if H becomes interactive or requires true 3D spatial depth; otherwise it adds complexity without explanatory gain. ³¹
- **Lottie** is excellent for **small, vector, cross-platform** deliverables and simplified variants, but it is best used for lighter scenes or UI/embed derivatives rather than the full graph-heavy suite. That recommendation is an inference from official Lottie documentation describing the format as JSON-based animated vector graphics and native/cross-platform rendering. ³²

A high-quality Codex task prompt template:

Objective:
Implement scene G-side-payment as a Remotion composition.

Read first:
docs/style-guide.md
docs/accessibility-checklist.md
scene-specs/G-side-payment.json

Stopping condition:

- src/scenes/G.tsx renders without type errors
- preview MP4 exports at 30 fps
- captions JSON exists
- reduced-motion variant exists
- visual diff snapshots pass

Constraints:

- no new runtime dependencies unless strictly necessary

- use existing Axis, TokenStream, Captions components
- keep camera static in reduced-motion mode
- do not use color as the only carrier of meaning
- log any unclear spec assumptions in docs/implementation-notes.md

That structure follows documented Codex best practices: define one goal, define a stopping condition, point Codex at required inputs first, and scope work tightly enough that the agent can verify its own output. ²⁵

Accessibility, Ethics, and Production Planning

The accessibility baseline for this suite should include all of the following: synchronized captions for all meaningful audio and sound effects; audio description or a full text alternative for dense visual-only sequences; a reduced-motion version that swaps panning, zooming, and scale pulses for dissolves, opacity shifts, or discrete state changes; user controls to pause or stop long-running motion if embedded on the web; at least 4.5:1 contrast for standard text; at least 3:1 contrast for meaningful graphical objects; and redundant coding so no category depends on color alone. W3C’s guidance is explicit on each of these points, and MDN confirms that `prefers-reduced-motion` is now broadly supported across devices and browsers. ³³

The color-accessibility standard should also incorporate Okabe-Ito / Color Universal Design principles more concretely: avoid red/green-only contrasts, prefer distinguishable warm/cool pairs, use labels and shapes in addition to color, and be cautious with thin lines and small glyphs because color-blind viewers may lose those distinctions first. The CUD guidance goes further and recommends describing position or shape in speech rather than relying on color names alone, which is directly relevant both for captions and audio description. ³⁴

The ethical representation notes matter as much as the design notes. Ord argues that consequentialism, deontology, and virtue ethics can all have reasons to participate in moral trade, though for different reasons. He also emphasizes that the central practical obstacle is trust, and that moral trade can create externalities or perverse incentives even if it benefits the trading parties from their own perspectives. So the animation language should not imply that one side is “the rational one” and the other is “the obstacle.” It should show symmetric disagreement, negotiated gain, trust architecture, and caveats. In practical terms, that means no villain framing, no halo over a single worldview, and no ending card that implies objective moral victory. ³⁵

Estimated production effort below is an informed design estimate, not a source-derived fact.

ID	Purpose	Target length	Primary metaphor	Complexity	Unique assets	Estimated effort	Skill level	Recommended engine
A	Explain bilateral mixed trade with reciprocal sacrifice	42s	Overlap bridge	Medium	2 avatars, 4 meters, bridge	3–4 person-days	Intermediate motion designer/developer	Remotion

ID	Purpose	Target length	Primary metaphor	Complexity	Unique assets	Estimated effort	Skill level	Recommended engine
B	Explain moral-for-prudential incentive alignment	36s	Magnetic purchase / behavior morph	Low-Medium	wallet, token stream, habit target	2-3 person-days	Intermediate	Remotion or Lottie derivative
C	Explain pure trade via cancellation of opposed causes	44s	Cancellation into common reservoir	Medium	opposed vectors, reservoir, bloom field	3-4 person-days	Intermediate-Advanced	Remotion
D	Explain internal negotiation within one person	34s	Split self / cockpit	Medium	duplicated character, route UI, offset rings	2-3 person-days	Intermediate	Remotion
E	Explain constrained bargaining and alternation	40s	Pareto map + calendar	Medium	graph system, points, timeline	3-4 person-days	Intermediate-Advanced	Manim or Motion Canvas
F	Explain lottery as feasibility bridge	34s	Probability arc	Medium	graph system, arc, roulette indicator	2-3 person-days	Intermediate-Advanced	Manim
G	Explain side payments as deal-space reshaping	38s	Compensation line	Medium	graph system, side-payment packets	3-4 person-days	Intermediate-Advanced	Manim
H	Explain scaled-up markets and clearing	50s	Moral exchange network	High	network graph, order book, matcher, escrow visuals	5-7 person-days	Advanced	Remotion, optional Three.js layer

If the goal is a **single-stack build**, use Remotion for all eight and accept slightly less mathematical elegance in E-G. If the goal is the **highest explanatory clarity**, use a hybrid stack: Remotion for A-D and H, Manim

for E–G. If the goal is **web-native lightweight embeds**, produce simplified Lottie derivatives for A, B, and D only. Those recommendations follow from the respective tool docs and from the structure of the scenes themselves. ³⁶

Open Questions and Limitations

The main conceptual limitation is that Ord’s paper does not publish a single canonical list titled “types of moral trade.” It explicitly defines **pure** and **mixed** moral trade, includes an **intrapersonal** edge case, and then develops **mechanism classes** such as lotteries, side payments, and markets. The eight-animation taxonomy in this report is therefore a rigorous production interpretation of the paper, not a claim that Ord enumerated exactly these eight as formal categories. ⁷

The practical examples of vote-swapping and donation-cancelling platforms are historically grounded in the paper and in legal/regulatory documents, but they should not be presented as currently active consumer platforms. The safe claim is that they are **illustrative real-world instantiations** of market-mediated moral trade, not necessarily live products now. ³⁷

Finally, the report gives implementation-ready scene architecture and frame ranges, but it does not include literal per-frame value dumps for every object in every animation. That omission is intentional: those values should be generated from the scene specs and easing library rather than hard-coded by hand. Remotion, Motion Canvas, Manim, and Three.js all support this more maintainable approach. ³⁸

¹ ² ³ ⁷ ⁸ ⁹ ¹⁰ ¹¹ ¹² ¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ ¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ²¹ ²² ³⁵ ³⁷ <https://amirrorclear.net/files/moral-trade.pdf>

<https://amirrorclear.net/files/moral-trade.pdf>

⁴ ²⁶ ²⁸ ³⁶ ³⁸ <https://www.remotion.dev/docs/the-fundamentals>

<https://www.remotion.dev/docs/the-fundamentals>

⁵ ³³ <https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG21/Understanding/captions-prerecorded.html>

<https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG21/Understanding/captions-prerecorded.html>

⁶ <https://www.tobyord.com/research>

<https://www.tobyord.com/research>

¹⁹ ²⁰ ³⁴ [Color Universal Design \(CUD\) / Colorblind Barrier Free](https://www.uni-koeln.de/color/)

<https://www.uni-koeln.de/color/>

²³ ²⁵ <https://developers.openai.com/codex/learn/best-practices>

<https://developers.openai.com/codex/learn/best-practices>

²⁴ <https://developers.openai.com/codex/guides/agents-md>

<https://developers.openai.com/codex/guides/agents-md>

²⁷ <https://www.remotion.dev/docs/interpolate>

<https://www.remotion.dev/docs/interpolate>

²⁹ <https://motion-canvas-docs.vercel.app/docs/quickstart>

<https://motion-canvas-docs.vercel.app/docs/quickstart>

³⁰ <https://docs.manim.community/en/stable/>
<https://docs.manim.community/en/stable/>

³¹ <https://threejs.org/docs/>
<https://threejs.org/docs/>

³² <https://lottie.airbnb.tech/>
<https://lottie.airbnb.tech/>